

Zoom Communications

NASDAQ : ZM · Mature-Company DCF · SOTP

\$107.43
\$33.09B mkt cap · 308M sh · \$7.9B cash, zero debt · Anthropic stake (carried)

THE CENTRAL QUESTION

Is Zoom a melting ice cube with locked-up optionality — or a stable cash machine sitting on a \$7B Anthropic stake the market hasn't yet marked to public?

Zoom trades at \$105.64 (\$32.5B mkt cap) on TTM revenue of ~\$4.94B, \$1.7B FCF, and \$7.9B cash & marketable securities — roughly a quarter of market cap is just cash. Q1 FY27 confirmed the base case: revenue \$1.24B (+5.5%, beat), FY27 guidance raised to \$5.09B / \$5.98 EPS, buyback expanded \$1.0B — management returning capital while it waits for the Anthropic mark. On top sits an Anthropic equity stake carried at cost but worth \$4-9B across scenarios, pending the IPO mark. The operating business is a stable cash machine (35-40% FCF margin) facing real but slow competition from Teams and Workspace. Mature-Company DCF with SOTP framing below. Three scenarios, weighted; show your work.

PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED EXPECTED VALUE

\$164.39
expected fair value today
+53.0% vs spot \$107.43

FORWARD COMPOUNDED VALUE

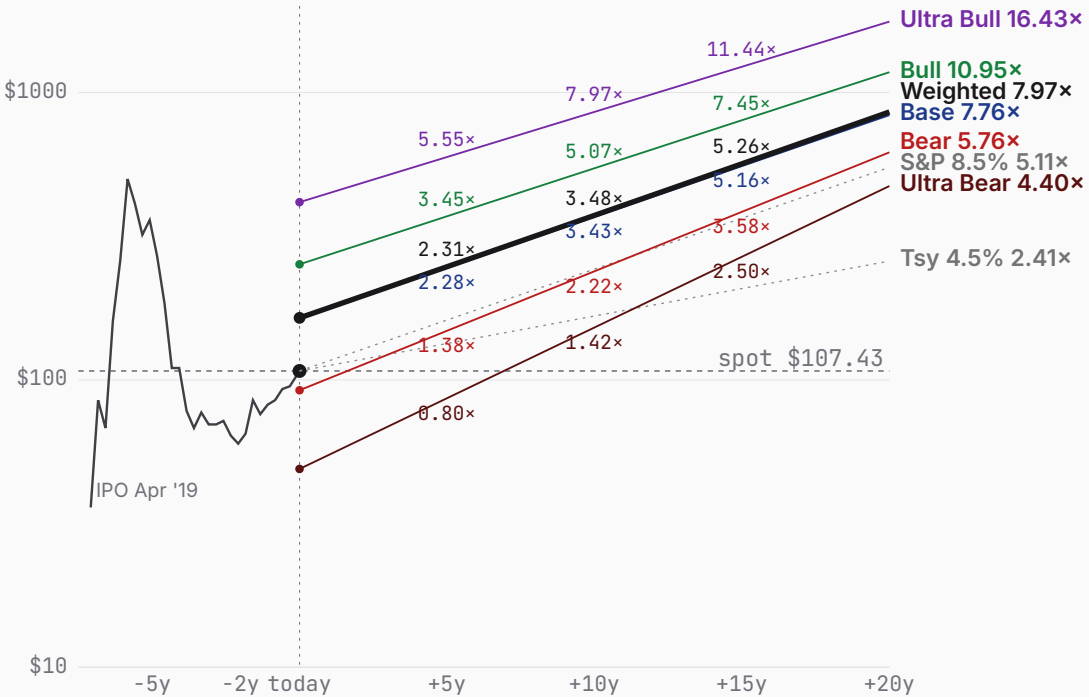
+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y
\$247.65	\$373.71	\$564.97	\$855.81
2.31× spot	3.48× spot	5.26× spot	7.97× spot

WEIGHTING RATIONALE

- Bear 30%** Teams/Workspace structurally favored; AI Companion fails to monetize; Anthropic stake compressed.
Base 50% Modal outcome: stable mid-single-digit growth, Anthropic IPOs at \$700B-1T, multiple modest expand.
Bull 15% AI Companion monetizes + Anthropic at \$1T+; two engines succeed independently.
Ultra Bull 5% Both engines fire simultaneously; Anthropic at \$2T+; multiple re-rates to growth-software premium.

Bull (15%) + Ultra Bull (5%) together contribute \$58.64 — 36% of the \$164.39 expected value despite 20% combined probability. Today's spot (\$107.43) sits 35% below the weighted expected; forward-weighted value crosses spot between +5y and +10y.

PRICE + PROJECTIONS · HISTORICAL THROUGH PROBABILITY-WEIGHTED FORWARD



ULTRA BEAR	\$49.00	BEAR	\$92.04	BASE	\$163.16	BULL	\$252.46	ULTRA BULL	\$415.40
	-54.4% vs spot		-14.3% vs spot		+51.9% vs spot		+135.0% vs spot		+286.7% vs spot
CAGR -5.8% WACC 12.0% Anth \$2B Prob 8%		CAGR -0.7% WACC 10.0% Anth \$4B Prob 22%		CAGR +3.1% WACC 8.5% Anth \$7B Prob 50%		CAGR +6.4% WACC 8.0% Anth \$9B Prob 15%		CAGR +9.5% WACC 7.5% Anth \$16B Prob 5%	
Cisco-Webex moment; -54% tail.		Zoom without a core market.		Stable cash machine with a visible kicker.		AI monetization + Anthropic re-rating.		Anthropic \$2T+; full re-rating.	



Zoom Communications scenario narratives

PROBABILITY WEIGHTS

Ultra Bear 8% Bear 22% Base 50% Bull 15% Ultra Bull 5% · Weighted expected \$164.39 (+53.0% vs spot)

ULTRA BEAR	\$49.00	BEAR	\$92.04	BASE	\$163.16	BULL	\$252.46	ULTRA BULL	\$415.40
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Probability 8%

Cisco-Webex moment; -54% tail.

WHY 8%

Joint conjunction of four independent fault lines: (a) Cisco-style displacement curve materializes (~10/-13/-19% YoY) — historical base rate of incumbent-SaaS displacement by hyperscaler bundles is real but not the median outcome; (b) Anthropic IPO disappoints below \$400B (vs current \$900B private mark) on AI-capex correction + Pentagon supply-chain risk + cheap-AI commoditization; (c) AI Companion Pro fails to monetize as Microsoft Copilot bundling collapses pricing power for collaboration AI; (d) Phone + Contact Center growth stalls below 15%, killing the diversification story. Each individually 15-30% probability conditional on macro; joint conjunction at 8%. Lower than bear's 22% because (i) Q1 FY27 just printed a beat with NDR ticking up to 99% and AI Companion MAUs +184% YoY, and (ii) compound conjunction requires all four to fire simultaneously over five years.

WHAT HAPPENS

The ultra-bear is qualitatively different from bear's slow melt. It's the Cisco Webex collaboration trajectory — revenue prints -10%, then -13%, then -19% YoY as Teams reaches its tipping point. Four things compound: enterprise NDR breaks 95% as Teams Premium pricing collapses ZM's seat economics; AI Companion Pro fails to differentiate against Copilot/Gemini bundled into M365 and Workspace; Phone + Contact Center growth stalls below 15% (the diversification story dies); and Anthropic IPOs at <\$400B (Pentagon supply-chain risk + AI-capex moderation + cheap-AI commoditization), gutting the SOTP "hidden asset" narrative.

Revenue collapses from \$4.87B to \$3.6B over five years (~26%). Op margin compresses from 36% to 12% as ZM spends defensively to retain the enterprise base. Terminal growth turns negative (~2%, perpetual decline). Op EV: \$5.7B. Cash drains from \$7.9B to ~\$5.5B as management runs \$1.5B/yr buybacks for two years before halting when the flywheel breaks. Anthropic stake floors at \$2B (sub-\$400B IPO). SOTP equity: \$13.2B ÷ 270M shares = ~\$49/share — a -54% tail, mirroring ultra_bull's +293% asymmetry.

Probability 22%

Zoom without a core market.

WHY 22%

Bearish thesis is competitive commoditization: Teams (Microsoft's bundled play) and Google Meet (free for Workspace customers) continue to take seats from ZM's enterprise base; AI Companion Pro fails to differentiate or monetize meaningfully (Microsoft Copilot integration into Teams is the obvious competitive response); Phone seats stagnate; Contact Center fails to reach scale; Anthropic stake gets compressed if AI valuations correct or Anthropic does an underwhelming IPO. The 30% weight reflects that Teams/Workspace competition is real, ongoing, and structurally favored — but ZM has shown unexpected resilience through 2024-25 (stable revenue, growing FCF, \$1B+ buyback program). Not bankruptcy risk; share-loss-with-margin-compression risk.

WHAT HAPPENS

The pessimistic case is harsh and worth taking seriously: video conferencing has commoditized. Microsoft Teams ships with every E3 and E5 license — well north of 400M enterprise seats globally. Google Meet ships with Workspace. Webex, Slack Huddles, Discord, FaceTime — everyone has video. The product Zoom invented and dominated is now table stakes inside the productivity bundles customers are already paying for.

In this world Zoom's revenue stagnates and then declines. Enterprise renewals come at lower seat counts as IT teams quietly migrate to Teams. Online (consumer + SMB) erodes faster as free alternatives become good enough. Phone and Contact Center continue growing 20-25%+ but on too small a base to offset the core decline. Revenue drifts from \$4.87B in FY26 to ~\$4.7B by FY30. Margins compress as Zoom spends to defend.

Probability 50%

Stable cash machine with a visible kicker.

WHY 50%

Modal outcome. ZM stabilizes at mid-single-digit revenue growth; FY27 guidance holds; AI Companion Pro is a meaningful contributor but not a category-defining product; Anthropic stake gets a public mark via Anthropic's IPO at \$700B-1T valuation; ZM multiple expands modestly as the market gives credit for the Anthropic stake AND for stable cash generation. Buyback compounds shares-out reduction at attractive prices. The 50% weight reflects that this requires the least faith — sequential execution on plans already in motion.

WHAT HAPPENS

The middle path. Zoom continues as a stable mid-single-digit growth business. Enterprise revenue grows 6-7%, Online stays flat to slightly down, Phone and Contact Center add 25%+ on smaller bases. Blended revenue grows 3-4% — exactly what FY27 guidance is calling for and consistent with the last two years.

AI Companion stays bundled into paid plans and helps justify price increases at renewal. The strategic logic is right: make AI a feature of the bundle rather than try to monetize it as a separate SKU customers can decline. Margins hold in the mid-30s after a near-term CapEx step-up for the post-pandemic data center refresh. Cash builds at \$1.7-1.9B/year. Some funds buybacks (current \$1B+ authorization), some sits.

Probability 15%

AI monetization + Anthropic re-rating.

WHY 15%

AI Companion Pro monetizes (per-seat add-on becomes meaningful contributor); Phone scales to 16M+ seats with margin expansion; Contact Center crosses \$500M ARR and becomes a real third leg of growth; Anthropic IPOs at \$1T+ with stake getting full mark (vs current discount carrying value); the operating business multiple expands AND the Anthropic stake appreciates. The 20% weight is higher than JOB/Y/AUR's bull weight because ZM's bull case is less compound — AI monetization and Anthropic appreciation are somewhat independent bets that can succeed without each other. But the conjunction still requires multiple things at once: product success on three new SKUs (Companion Pro, Phone scale, Contact Center scale) plus a favorable AI capital markets backdrop for Anthropic's IPO.

WHAT HAPPENS

The bull case requires Zoom to convert AI Companion into a meaningful per-seat upsell while Anthropic IPOs at \$1T+. AI Companion Pro reaches material adoption — call it 15% attach on paid seats at \$5-8/month uplift — adds ~\$300M ARR by FY28. Phone scales to 16M seats with margin expansion. Contact Center crosses \$500M ARR and becomes a real third leg of growth. Blended revenue growth re-accelerates to 5-8%.

FCF margin expands toward 40%+ as the AI Companion uplift drops to the bottom line at ~80% gross margin. Cash generation hits \$2.2-2.5B/yr. Aggressive buybacks at 130-150 retire 70M+ shares over 5 years. SOTP math: \$43.8B op EV + \$7.8B cash + \$9B Anthropic = \$60.6B equity ÷ 240M FY30 shares = \$253/share.

Probability 5%

Anthropic \$2T+; full re-rating.

WHY 5%

Joint conditional: Anthropic IPO above \$2T (60% conditional on IPO) AND AI Companion crosses \$1B ARR (40% conditional on existing trajectory) AND multiple re-rates from 15x to 30x P/FCF (50% conditional on growth + AI both firing). Joint at 5-7%, reflected here at 5%. This is the scenario where ZM stops being a 'value with AI optionality' name and becomes a growth-software name with an emerging-leader AI partner. Tail of tails.

WHAT HAPPENS

The ultra-bull case is that the two engines BOTH fire and the market re-rates the equity to growth-software multiples. Anthropic IPOs at \$2T+ valuation (vs \$1T base bull), marking the Anthropic stake at \$14-18B — 2× the bull-case carry value. Simultaneously, AI Companion Pro becomes a real revenue engine: 30%+ paid-seat attach at \$8-12/mo, hitting \$1B+ ARR by FY29 and reaccelerating core revenue growth to 8-10%. Phone, Contact Center, and Workvivo each become \$500M+ ARR contributors.

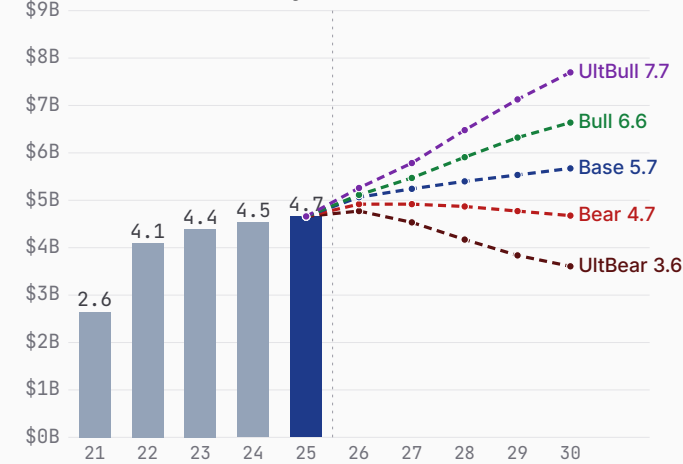
Multiple expands from current 15x P/FCF to 30x+ as the growth story consolidates. SOTP math: \$80B+ operating EV + \$7.8B cash + \$16B Anthropic (mid-case mark) = \$103B equity ÷ 250M FY30 shares = \$412/share. The ultra-bull is materially different from bull: not just AI works AND Anthropic works, but BOTH inflect AT THE SAME TIME and the market rerates accordingly.

Zoom Communications business snapshot

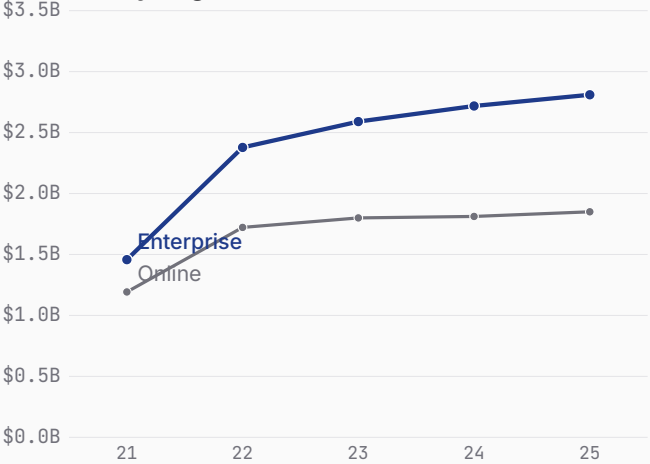
Bear \$92.04 Base \$163.16 Bull \$252.46

FY21–FY25 history + FY26–FY30 scenario projections · fiscal years end Jan 31 · 10-K FY26, Q1 2026 10-Q, Anthropic press releases

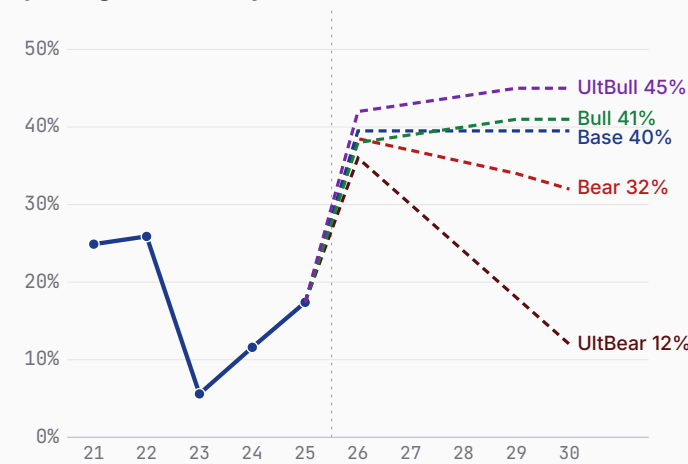
Revenue (\$B) — history + scenarios to FY30



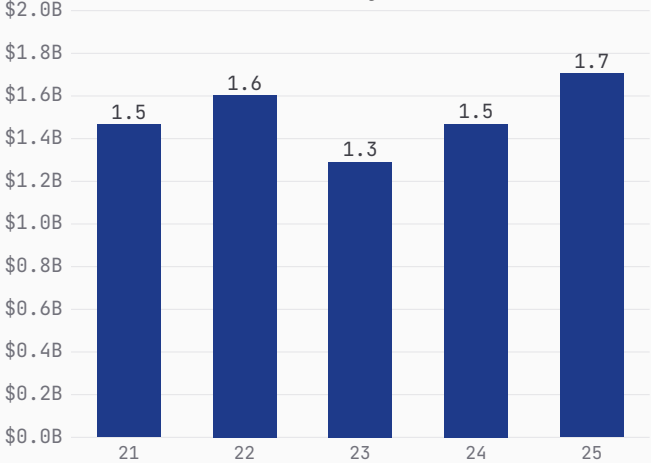
Revenue by segment (\$B)



Op margin — history + scenarios



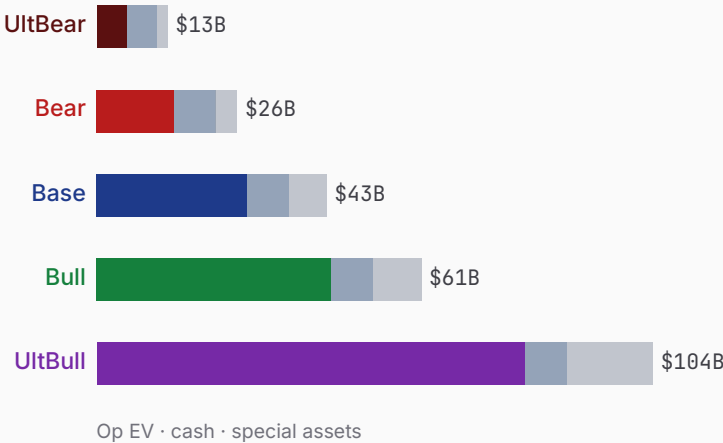
Free cash flow (\$B) — history



EV / Revenue — historical

(no EV history data)

SOTP equity (Op EV + cash + Anthropic)



Sources: ZM 10-K FY26, Q1 2026 10-Q, Anthropic financial press, AI infrastructure peer set.

Zoom Communications 7 Powers · the moat, scored

Bear \$92.04 Base \$163.16 Bull \$252.46

Arena. Video communications + collaboration — Zoom vs Microsoft Teams (bundled in M365), Google Meet (Workspace), Cisco Webex; the question is whether a standalone platform holds against suite bundling, and whether AI Companion monetizes.

POWER AUDIT
dominant-power durability: medium

POWER AUDIT · 7 POWERS

Scale Economies 	Large user base + global media infrastructure spread cost.
Network Economies 	Ubiquity ('Zoom me'), guest-join reach, app marketplace.
Counter-Positioning 	Was the ease-of-use disruptor; incumbents have since matched the model.
Switching Costs 	Enterprise contracts; Zoom Phone / Contact Center stickiness; habit.
Branding ◀ thesis leans here 	Category-defining verb; default for external meetings.
Cornered Resource 	No durable exclusive asset; talent + reliability are replicable.
Process Power 	Reliability/UX engineering culture; uptime track record.

PEER SET

Microsoft Teams Bundled free in M365 — the existential bundling threat.	10% gr · 40% mgn · bundled
Google Meet Bundled in Workspace; good-enough for many.	8% gr · 30% mgn · bundled
Cisco Webex Enterprise legacy; declining share.	-5% gr · 25% mgn · ~12x
RingCentral / 8x8 UCaaS pure-plays in Phone/CC.	5% gr · 18% mgn · ~8x

THREAT VECTORS · FALSIFIERS

Counter-Positioning · Microsoft Teams (bundling)
falsifier: Online seat growth < 0% or net-dollar-retention < 100% as Teams bundling displaces standalone seats.

Branding · AI assistants (Copilot/Gemini)
falsifier: AI Companion fails to lift ARPU while bundled rivals give equivalent AI free.

COMPETITIVE READ

A category-defining brand + network with real switching costs, but durability is the whole debate — Microsoft's bundling is the dominant threat the terminal multiple hinges on; seat growth and net retention are the gauges.

Zoom Communications show your work

Bear \$92.04 Base \$163.16 Bull \$252.46 · Weighted \$164.39 (+53.0%)

ULTRA BEAR\$49.00					BEAR\$92.04					BASE\$163.16					BULL\$252.46					ULTRA BULL\$415.40				
ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS					ASSUMPTIONS				
5y revenue CAGR (%)					-5.8					5y revenue CAGR (%)					-0.7					5y revenue CAGR (%)				
Year-5 op margin (%)					12.0					Year-5 op margin (%)					32.0					Year-5 op margin (%)				
WACC (%)					12.0					WACC (%)					10.0					WACC (%)				
Terminal growth (%)					-2.0					Terminal growth (%)					0.0					Terminal growth (%)				
Anthropic stake (\$B)					2.0					Anthropic stake (\$B)					4.0					Anthropic stake (\$B)				
Starting revenue (\$B)					4.87					Starting revenue (\$B)					4.87					Starting revenue (\$B)				
Scenario probability (%)					8					Scenario probability (%)					22					Scenario probability (%)				
5-YEAR DCF · \$B					5-YEAR DCF · \$B					5-YEAR DCF · \$B					5-YEAR DCF · \$B					5-YEAR DCF · \$B				
FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF	FY	Rev	Margin	FCF	PV FCF
FY26	4.77	+36%	+1.72	+1.53	FY26	4.92	+39%	+1.72	+1.57	FY26	5.06	+40%	+1.77	+1.63	FY26	5.11	+38%	+1.94	+1.80	FY26	5.26	+42%	+2.14	+1.99
FY27	4.53	+30%	+1.36	+1.08	FY27	4.92	+37%	+1.67	+1.38	FY27	5.24	+40%	+1.83	+1.56	FY27	5.47	+39%	+2.13	+1.83	FY27	5.79	+43%	+2.56	+2.21
FY28	4.17	+24%	+1.00	+0.71	FY28	4.87	+36%	+1.61	+1.21	FY28	5.40	+40%	+1.89	+1.48	FY28	5.91	+40%	+2.36	+1.88	FY28	6.48	+44%	+3.02	+2.42
FY29	3.84	+18%	+0.69	+0.44	FY29	4.77	+34%	+1.48	+1.01	FY29	5.53	+40%	+1.94	+1.40	FY29	6.32	+41%	+2.59	+1.91	FY29	7.13	+45%	+3.35	+2.50
FY30	3.61	+12%	+0.43	+0.25	FY30	4.68	+32%	+1.36	+0.84	FY30	5.67	+40%	+1.99	+1.32	FY30	6.64	+41%	+2.72	+1.85	FY30	7.70	+45%	+3.58	+2.48
Σ PV explicit FCF					+4.02					Σ PV explicit FCF					+7.39					Σ PV explicit FCF				
+ PV terminal (g -2.0%)					1.72					+ PV terminal (g 0.0%)					20.72					+ PV terminal (g 2.5%)				
+ PV terminal (g 2.0%)					8.42					+ PV terminal (g 2.0%)					34.52					+ PV terminal (g 3.0%)				
EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE					EQUITY BUILD · \$B & PER SHARE				
Operating EV					\$5.74B					Operating EV					\$14.43B					Operating EV				
+ Cash & investments					\$5.50B					+ Cash & investments					\$7.80B					+ Cash & investments				
+ Anthropic stake					\$2.00B					+ Anthropic stake					\$4.00B					+ Anthropic stake				
= Equity value					\$13.24B					= Equity value					\$26.23B					= Equity value				
FY30 shares (M)					270					FY30 shares (M)					285					FY30 shares (M)				
= Expected per share					\$49.00					= Expected per share					\$92.04					= Expected per share				
FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT					FUTURE FAIR VALUE · IF SCENARIO PLAYS OUT				
+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y		+5y	+10y	+15y	+20y	
\$86.35	\$152.19	\$268.20	\$472.67		\$148.23	\$238.73	\$384.47	\$619.20		\$245.34	\$368.90	\$554.70	\$834.08		\$370.95	\$545.04	\$800.85	\$1,176.71		\$596.36	\$856.15	\$1,229.12	\$1,764.56	
0.80×	1.42×	2.50×	4.40×		1.38×	2.22×	3.58×	5.76×		2.28×	3.43×	5.16×	7.76×		3.45×	5.07×	7.45×	10.95×		5.55×	7.97×	11.44×	16.43×	



Zoom Communications People · Opportunity · Context · Deal

Bear \$92.04 Base \$163.16 Bull \$252.46

Underwrite the position the way a venture investor underwrites a round — across all four legs, public or private. **People** is the leg scored here (observable only); Opportunity, Context and Deal cross-reference the rest of the memo.

PEOPLE · WHO RUNS / OWNS / FUNDS IT

Eric S. Yuan · founder-led 15 yrs in seat

8% insider ownership HIGH key-person risk

Capital allocation (realized)
Net cash ~\$7.7B, zero debt — now being returned: stacked buyback authorizations (\$1.5B 2024 → +\$1.2B → +\$1.0B → +\$1.0B 2026). The one big swing — the \$14.7B all-stock Five9 bid (2021) — was terminated when Five9 holders rejected it; no overpriced deal got done.

Incentive alignment
Founder equity is the alignment: 2023 base salary cut to \$10,000 (~98%) with bonus declined; no extra board pay. Comp is shifting from annual equity toward cash bonus (FY26–27).

GOVERNANCE FLAGS

- super-voting dual-class (Class B = 10 votes) → ~25–30%+ founder voting control
- CEO + Chairman combined
- lead independent director; ~9 of 10 directors independent

PEOPLE READ

Founder-owner-operator (~8% economic, \$10k salary) returning the \$7.7B cash hoard via buybacks, with a majority-independent board — disciplined and aligned; the offsets are super-voting control (~25–30%+ of votes), a combined CEO/Chair, and high key-person concentration on Yuan.

THE FOUR LEGS

People observable composite · 1–5

Opportunity
The scenario distribution · the business snapshot · the Arthur Indicator (ZM 6.4)

Context
The 7 Powers analysis (Power Audit)

Deal
Open-market common — entry price weighed against the probability-weighted fair value (the +56% finding), then position-sized.

Zoom Communications

supporting analysis · disclaimers · glossary

Bear \$92.04 Base \$163.16 Bull \$252.46

PUSHBACK · WHY THE BASE CASE IS TOO HARSH

- 1

Operating business has resilience.
ZM revenue stable through 2024-25 despite Teams competition. Phone + Contact Center grew 25%+. Resilience visible, not theoretical.
- 2

AI Companion strategy is right.
Bundle AI into existing plans rather than separate SKU. Microsoft Copilot's \$30/seat model is the cautionary tale — adoption underwhelmed.
- 3

\$7.8B cash is a real floor.
25% of market cap is liquid. T-bills earn ~4%. Optionality for M&A, buybacks, or capital return. Hard to lose money against this.
- 4

Anthropic stake is asymmetric.
Carried at cost (\$1.5B); worth \$4-9B today; could mark to \$15B+ post-IPO. Hidden asset most screeners ignore.
- 5

Capital allocation track record.
\$1B+ buyback authorization announced 2024. Avg buyback price below \$80. Eric Yuan personally aligned (15%+ owner).

FALSIFICATION TRIGGERS

Bear validation FY27 revenue declines · AI Companion attach < 5% on paid seats · Anthropic IPO marks stake below \$5B · Phone seat growth < 15%	Bull validation FY27 revenue re-accelerates > 5% · AI Companion attach > 10% · Anthropic IPO at \$1T+ · Contact Center crosses \$500M ARR	Reframe needed If Eric Yuan executes major M&A (>\$3B deal) — repurposing cash from optionality to platform expansion; both bear and bull theses get rewritten
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Forward-looking statements. Scenarios, valuations, projections, and any forward-looking statements involve substantial assumptions and uncertainty. Actual results may differ materially from those projected. Past performance is not indicative of future results. The model is a model; reality is not.	Author may hold positions. The author may own, intend to acquire, or hold short exposure to \$ZM or related securities at any time. Positions may change without notice and without an update to this document. Do not assume the author's positions match the tone of the analysis.	Do your own research. Do not make investment decisions on the basis of this document. Consult a licensed financial professional and read the company's official SEC filings (10-K, 10-Q, 8-K, proxy) before forming any investment view. If you wouldn't trust your retirement to a chatbot, don't trust this either.

GLOSSARY · CONCEPTS REFERENCED IN THE NARRATIVE

AI Companion / Pro — ZM's AI assistant. Bundled free into paid plans (Companion) with a premium SKU (Pro). Bundle-not-separate-SKU strategy.	Phone — ZM's cloud PBX product. ~9M seats currently, growing 25%+. Cross-sells off the meetings install base; a third-leg growth driver.	Contact Center — ZM's CCaaS product (cloud-based customer service). ~\$200M ARR currently, growing fast; bull case crosses \$500M ARR.
Anthropic stake — ZM invested in Anthropic 2023. Carrying value disclosed at ~\$1.5B; market value \$4-9B across scenarios pending the IPO mark.	SOTP — Sum-of-the-parts: operating EV + cash + special assets - debt. Used when material balance-sheet value sits outside operations.	Buyback flywheel — ZM generates \$1.7-2.4B FCF/yr. Buybacks at \$1-1.5B/yr retire shares; lower share count compounds per-share value.